LAGOS BUSINESS SCHOOL · PAN-ATLANTIC UNIVERSITY

Turning Data into Business Growth

Participant guide · five days of judgement, in a world where the code writes itself

DATES
12–16 October 2026

VENUE
LBS Campus, Ajah, Lagos

ACADEMIC DIRECTOR
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THIS GUIDE BELONGS TO

MY DRIVER / SCEPTIC PARTNER

MY CAPSTONE IN ONE LINE

Four mechanics do most of the teaching

Executive programmes about AI share a characteristic failure mode: the room watches a series of fluent demonstrations, agrees they were impressive, and returns to work able to do very little differently. The demonstrations are enjoyable *because* they are frictionless — but the friction was never incidental to the learning, it was the learning. These four mechanics exist to put it back on purpose.

The four-minute rule

No demonstration runs longer than four minutes before the room does it too. Watching is orientation up to that point and entertainment after it, so if a facilitator overruns you are entitled to say so out loud.

Driver and Sceptic

You work in pairs, roles swapped daily. The Driver is on the keyboard. The Sceptic may not touch it and must produce an objection *before* a result is used — which is the harder of the two seats, as most pairs discover.

Salted data

Thirteen deliberate defects across the data room — unevenly spread, and some files entirely clean. You will present findings that turn out to be wrong, as everyone does, faculty included. That is the design working.

The failure logbook

Every table keeps a record of what the assistant got wrong and the question that caught it. On Friday the entries are consolidated into one page and sent to the whole cohort.

The seven questions

Not one of these requires you to write code: they are questions about meaning rather than syntax, which is why they travel back to your own desk unchanged. Together they catch most of what goes wrong in commercial analytics. Tear this page out if it helps.

1. What is the **grain** of this table?
   One row per what?
2. How many rows **before the join**, and how many after?
   If it changed and nobody predicted it, stop.
3. What **period** am I comparing to what period?
   Are they the same length?
4. **Real or nominal**?
   And if real, deflated by what?
5. Would I have known this **at the moment I needed to act**?
   The leakage test. It is a question about time.
6. What had to be **true for a row to exist** in this file?
   Survivorship, and the filter on the extract.

7 If this result is **this good**, what is wrong with it?

An unexpectedly good result is a bug report.

One number, with an interval, every morning

Write the number you currently believe, the range you would be willing to bet inside four times out of five, and the single assumption that range depends on. Fifteen minutes, no discussion, and do not look back at yesterday's entry before you write today's — the comparison is more informative if each morning is written fresh.

WHY THE INTERVAL MATTERS MORE THAN THE NUMBER

For most people, across the week, the number itself moves only a little and the interval gets **wider**. That looks at first like going backwards, and it is the opposite: you now know more about what you do not know, which is the precondition for every good decision made with data. A confident point estimate that turns out to be wrong is a far more expensive object than a range you understood the shape of.

	THE NUMBER I NOW BELIEVE	MY 80% RANGE	THE ASSUMPTION IT RESTS ON
Day 1 Monday			
Day 2 Tuesday			
Day 3 Wednesday			
Day 4 Thursday			
Day 5 Friday			

FRIDAY, BEFORE THE DEFENCE

Put Monday's card next to Friday's and read them together. Which of the two moved more — the number, or the interval? And what did you learn this week that explains it?

THE ONE NUMBER IN MY ORGANISATION THAT IS SUBMITTED AS A POINT AND SHOULD BE A RANGE

WHO WOULD HAVE TO AGREE TO CHANGE IT

Your capstone starts here

Submitted ten days before Monday, revised in Lab 1, pinned to the wall board all week and defended on Friday afternoon. It is worth choosing a problem you genuinely want an answer to rather than a safe one, because you will be living with it for five days. Write the version you are willing to be held to.

1 · THE DECISION

Which recurring decision does this change? Who makes it? How often? What are their current options?

2 · THE NUMBER

Which node on your KPI tree moves? Its exact definition, in a sentence that survives cross-examination. Where it sits today.

3 · THE VALUE

One line of arithmetic. Three assumptions, ranked. A range, not a point.

4 · THE DATA

Three tables. Their grain. History or snapshot. Who owns access. What is most likely to be wrong with them.

5 · THE EVIDENCE STANDARD

How will you know afterwards whether it worked? “Nothing” is acceptable on Monday and unacceptable on Friday.

6 · WHOSE JUDGEMENT THIS DISPLACES

Name them. What will they say? What would make them an ally?

7 · THE 90-DAY PLAN

Three milestones. The first is within a fortnight and needs nobody’s permission.

WORKING NOTES ON THE CHARTER

MONDAY 12 OCTOBER

Strategy, value, and what AI actually changed

WHAT TODAY ARGUES

1. Analytics creates value in four ways, and most spend goes to the weakest one.
2. A KPI nobody owns, or that two departments define differently, is not a KPI.
3. AI made typing cheap. The bottleneck moved to judgement.

THE SESSIONS

09:15	**1.1**	Competing on analytics
10:45	**1.2**	The KPI tree
11:45	**1.3**	Sizing the prize
13:45	**1.4**	What AI actually changed
14:45	**1.5**	Where the data lives
15:45	**Lab 1**	The use-case charter

CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT BY 17:00

Charter on the wall board, attacked by your Sceptic.

MY SCEPTIC TODAY IS

THE OBJECTION THEY MADE THAT I DID NOT HAVE AN ANSWER TO

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER FROM TODAY

Lab notes

WHAT I DID

WHAT SURPRISED ME

FAILURE LOGBOOK — DAY 1

#	WHAT THE ASSISTANT PRODUCED	WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT	THE QUESTION THAT CAUGHT IT

TUESDAY 13 OCTOBER

DAY 2

Getting data you can trust

WHAT TODAY ARGUES

1. SQL is the lingua franca, and it is now a reading skill rather than a writing one.
2. The row counts that needed a warehouse project now run on your laptop, offline.
3. A join is a claim about cardinality. Most disasters are joins, grains, definitions and calendars.
4. Data quality is business rules that cannot be false, run automatically, forever.

THE SESSIONS

09:15	**2.1**	SQL as the lingua franca
10:45	**2.2**	The laptop warehouse
11:45	**2.3**	Excel as the bridge
13:45	**2.4**	Joins that lie
14:45	**2.5**	Data quality as a contract
15:45	**Lab 2**	The pipeline that reruns

CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT BY 16:45

Your pipeline runs, end to end, from a terminal.

MY SCEPTIC TODAY IS

THE OBJECTION THEY MADE THAT I DID NOT HAVE AN ANSWER TO

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER FROM TODAY

Lab notes

WHAT I DID

WHAT SURPRISED ME

FAILURE LOGBOOK — DAY 2

#	WHAT THE ASSISTANT PRODUCED	WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT	THE QUESTION THAT CAUGHT IT

WEDNESDAY 14 OCTOBER

Seeing, forecasting, segmenting

DAY 3

WHAT TODAY ARGUES

1. EDA is not a warm-up. The question is “what is odd here?”
2. A chart is an argument. The title is the claim.
3. A forecast without an interval is a wish.
4. Model quality that arrives suspiciously easily is evidence something leaked.

THE SESSIONS

09:15	**3.1**	What is odd here?
10:45	**3.2**	Charts that survive a board room
11:45	**3.3**	Forecasting with intervals
13:45	**3.4**	Segmentation you can act on
14:45	**3.5**	Propensity and the leak
15:45	**Lab 3**	The forecast market

CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT BY 16:45

Your model scores, with an interval and a leakage check on every feature.

MY SCEPTIC TODAY IS

THE OBJECTION THEY MADE THAT I DID NOT HAVE AN ANSWER TO

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER FROM TODAY

Lab notes

WHAT I DID

WHAT SURPRISED ME

FAILURE LOGBOOK — DAY 3

#	WHAT THE ASSISTANT PRODUCED	WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT	THE QUESTION THAT CAUGHT IT

THURSDAY 15 OCTOBER

Unstructured data and the executive narrative

WHAT TODAY ARGUES

1. Text is data. A theme with a volume attached is a business case.
2. A classifier is a measurement instrument. Calibrate it against hand-labelled truth.
3. A dashboard is finished when you can name the decision and the action each state triggers.
4. The report, deck, dashboard and appendix are four outputs of one source.

THE SESSIONS

09:15	**4.1**	Text as data
10:45	**4.2**	LLM classification at scale
11:45	**4.3**	Dashboards that get used
13:45	**4.4**	One source, five outputs
14:45	**4.5**	The executive narrative
15:45	**Lab 4**	The one-number brief

CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT BY 16:45

Dashboard and memo exist, both generated from the pipeline.

MY SCEPTIC TODAY IS

THE OBJECTION THEY MADE THAT I DID NOT HAVE AN ANSWER TO

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER FROM TODAY

Lab notes

WHAT I DID

WHAT SURPRISED ME

FAILURE LOGBOOK — DAY 4

#	WHAT THE ASSISTANT PRODUCED	WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT	THE QUESTION THAT CAUGHT IT

FRIDAY 16 OCTOBER

Proof, governance and the capstone



WHAT TODAY ARGUES

1. A SHAP value is a contribution to a prediction, not a causal driver.
2. An experiment is the cheapest way to end an argument. The SRM check comes first.
3. You usually cannot randomise. Say so, and state the weaker claim honestly.
4. Governance is a model card somebody fills in and a named person who can stop a deployment.

THE SESSIONS

09:15	**5.1**	Correlation, contribution, cause
10:45	**5.2**	Experiments that settle arguments
11:45	**5.3**	When you cannot randomise
13:15	**5.4**	Governance you can actually run
14:00	**5.5**	The operating model
15:30	**Defence**	Capstone, before the panel

CAPSTONE CHECKPOINT BY 14:30

Model card, lawful basis, and five minutes in front of the panel.

MY SCEPTIC TODAY IS

THE OBJECTION THEY MADE THAT I DID NOT HAVE AN ANSWER TO

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER FROM TODAY

Lab notes

WHAT I DID

WHAT SURPRISED ME

FAILURE LOGBOOK — DAY 5

#	WHAT THE ASSISTANT PRODUCED	WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT	THE QUESTION THAT CAUGHT IT

The marking criteria, published before the programme starts

A rubric you can see on Monday changes how you work all week. A rubric you see on Friday only allocates marks after the fact, which is why this one is published before the programme begins. Nothing on this page changes during the week.

DIMENSION	HIGH MARK	LOW MARK
Business impact 40%	A named recurring decision and decision-maker. Value with a range and three ranked assumptions. An honest statement of what happens if they are wrong.	"This gives the business visibility." No owner, no cadence, a point estimate with no range.
Analytical rigour 30%	Grain stated for every table. Defects found and handled. Leakage checked feature by feature. Uncertainty quantified. Naive benchmark reported.	Numbers with no provenance. A model with no benchmark. A causal verb with correlational evidence.
Communication 20%	Number and action in the first sentence. Interval with its driving assumption named. One chart that makes the case. Survives interruption.	Three paragraphs of background. Four charts, none decisive. "We recommend continued monitoring."
Feasibility & governance 10%	A 90-day plan whose first milestone needs nobody's permission. Lawful basis. Model card. The displaced person named.	A roadmap requiring a platform purchase. No lawful basis. Nobody loses, apparently.

A CAPSTONE CANNOT PASS ON RIGOUR ALONE

A technically immaculate analysis of a decision nobody makes scores 30 out of 100. That weighting is deliberate rather than harsh: it is roughly how value is distributed in the world outside this room, where the best-executed answer to the wrong question is still worth nothing.

THE SIX QUESTIONS THE PANEL WILL ASK

1. What is the grain of this table?
2. Would you have known this at the time you needed to act?
3. Is that real or nominal?
4. How would you know if you were wrong?
5. Who loses if this works?
6. Which of these numbers did the assistant produce, and which did you check?

Five minutes, and the five questions you hope nobody asks

THE FIVE MINUTES

0:00–0:30	The number and the action. One sentence. Then stop for two seconds.
0:30–1:15	The confidence. The interval, and the assumption driving its width.
1:15–1:45	The ask. Specific, addressed, dated.
1:45–3:00	The evidence. Source, grain, period, what you found wrong and what you did.
3:00–3:45	The evidence standard. Concede it before you are asked.
3:45–4:15	Governance, and the first 90-day milestone.
4:15–5:00	What happens if you are wrong, and how you would find out.

Then four minutes of questions from the panel. Three parallel rooms from 15:30, and everybody presents — the rehearsal earlier in the afternoon is there to make this the second time you have said it out loud rather than the first.

THE FIVE QUESTIONS I MOST HOPE NOBODY ASKS — AND MY ANSWERS

BEFORE I STAND UP

- [ ] First sentence contains a number, a verb and a date.
- [ ] The interval is stated, and the assumption that drives its width is named.
- [ ] I can state the grain of every table I used.
- [ ] Every feature in my model has passed the leakage question.
- [ ] Every number is real or nominal, and I know which.
- [ ] My causal verbs match my evidence. I audited them.
- [ ] I can name the evidence standard my claim rests on, and the stronger design I would run next.
- [ ] Model card written. Lawful basis identified. Human review defined.
- [ ] The 90-day plan’s first milestone needs nobody’s permission.
- [ ] I have named the person whose judgement this displaces.
- [ ] The brief regenerates from the pipeline. I tested this today.

Twelve terms

Grain	What one row represents. “One row per depot per SKU per week.” If you cannot say it, you cannot trust any total.
Fan-out	A join that multiplies rows because the “one” side has more than one row. Count rows before and after.
Leakage	A feature encoding information not available when you would act. Announces itself as success, not as error.
Lift	How much better the top-scored group is than a random group of the same size. Report this, not AUC.
MASE	Forecast error divided by the naive benchmark’s. Below 1 you beat naive; above 1 you did not.
SRM	Sample ratio mismatch. The arms are not the sizes randomisation predicts. Invalidates; cannot be adjusted away.
Parallel trends	The assumption under difference-in-differences. Plot the pre-period and show it.
SHAP value	A contribution to one prediction. Not a causal driver.
Survivorship	Analysing a population defined by having already succeeded. Ask what had to be true for a row to exist.
Nominal vs real	As recorded, versus adjusted for inflation. Ask “real or nominal?” first, then “deflated by what?”
Model card	One page per model. The lines everybody skips are “Not for” and “Retire by”.
Data contract	Business rules that cannot be false, checked automatically, with a severity on each.

Four prompt patterns that change the output

Give it the shape, not the data

Column names, types, row count, date range, and the grain sentence. Three lines. Removes most hallucinated column names.

Ask for the check, not just the answer

“Write the query, then write a second query that would detect if the first is wrong.”

Make it argue against itself

“Give me the three strongest reasons this result might be an artefact of the data rather than a fact about the business.”

The one to keep permanently

“Every number that appears in prose must be inline code. Do not hard-code any figure anywhere in the document text.”

AND THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST

None of these gives an assistant the ability to know things about your business that nobody has told it. It does not know that your fiscal year starts in April, that a negative quantity is a legitimate return in your ERP rather than an error, or that account numbers beginning `07` are dormant by convention. The fix is not a cleverer prompt. The fix is you, spending two minutes typing the context that only you have.

Day 30, Day 60, Day 90

Most executive programmes end on Friday afternoon, the charter goes into a drawer, and six months later the honest summary is that it was a good week. That is what happens to any piece of work with no next date attached to it, so three dates are attached to this one.

DAY 30 · THE CLINIC — WEDNESDAY 11 NOVEMBER 2026

A clinic rather than a webinar: bring whatever is stuck and we work on it together. Usually that is the pipeline that ran in the classroom and does not run at the office, the access request that never arrived, or the decision-maker who has not yet changed what they do — and the third is the one the clinic really exists for.

WHAT I WILL BRING

DAY 60 · THE PEER CALL — WEEK OF 14 DECEMBER 2026

Ten minutes each, then twenty-five on whoever is more stuck. What is the number now, and the interval around it? Did you do what you said you would in the first fortnight? What is blocking you? And what do you need from the other person — a contact, a review, or somebody senior saying the thing you have been saying?

MY ASSIGNED PEER

DAY 90 · THE COHORT RECONVENES — THURSDAY 14 JANUARY 2027

Everybody shows the number that moved, and how they know it moved because of what they did. The evidence standard is now enforced: “we will compare before and after” was a plan in October; in January it is a finding, and the panel will ask what else changed in the same period.

THE NUMBER I INTEND TO SHOW, AND HOW I WILL KNOW IT MOVED

THE ONE THING TO DO IN THE FIRST FORTNIGHT

The temptation is to improve the model or smarten the dashboard; neither is the right first move. **Run the pipeline at your desk, on your own machine, on real data, once.** Whatever breaks when you do is the actual gap between the classroom and your organisation, and it is the one milestone that needs nobody else's permission and nobody else's calendar.

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